

EXAMINED

FiiO X7 MarK II

The FiiO X7 MarK II is a portable, Android-based, high-res lossless audio music player.

The portable player runs on Android 5.1 and houses 2GB of RAM and 64GB of internal storage with 2 micro-SD card slots, each of which can support 256GB expansion cards. You should have no trouble storing as much lossless music as you want on this device with that much storage space on hand.

The X7 MarK II uses the 8-channel ESS ES9028PRO DAC. It's signal-to-noise (SNR) ratio is 129dB and the total harmonic distortion plus noise (THD + N) is -120dB. It's also capable of skipping Android's native audio re-sampling (ASRC).

The X7 MarK II also comes with a new amp module, the AM3A. It comes with both single-ended and balanced headphone outputs. It also uses the AD8620 JFET operational amplifier

(op-amp) and the OPA926 op-amp, which was designed exclusively for the X7 MarK II.

The MarK II utilises three crystal oscillators - one for the DSD and 44.1

kHz multiples sampling rates, one for 48kHz sampling rates, and one for the 384 kHz sampling rate.

In terms of looks, the X7 MarK II features a new design as compared to the original X7. It shares design elements from the X5 3rd gen like the side-mounted volume wheel with its 45-degree etched lines and the red ring around the power button. And even if you haven't really used the X7 or the X5 3rd gen, this one does tick the right boxes in the looks department.

The X7 MarK II also features a 480x800 in-cell touchscreen. As compared to the original X7, the X7 MarK II is 1.2mm shorter in length, slimmer by 1 mm and lighter by 10g. They've also improved on the wireless connectivity on the MarK II as compared to the original X7. It supports Bluetooth 4.1 and aptX standards. You should be able to pair it with just about any Bluetooth device out there, say, your existing pair of bluetooth headphones.



Corsair MM800 RGB Polaris

Another RGB mousepad makes its way into our test labs and this time it's from Corsair. Previously, the GALAX SNPR RGB mousepad caught a lot of eyeballs from everyone at work but looks like the MM800 RGB Polaris is getting more attention right now. Although both the mousepads are fundamentally the same, a few but major differences makes the MM800 more appealing. To begin with, the MM800 includes software support through the Corsair Utility Engine. This enables easier control over the lighting effects on the LED strip around the mousepad. There are seven presets available in the software and few of those effects can be tinkered to achieve different lighting effects. This is far easier than cycling through different lighting effects with two buttons as seen on the GALAX SNPR

mousepad. Importing preset lighting profiles isn't supported yet in the software. But since the same feature is available for their other RGB products, it might make its way to this one in the future. The other interesting feature on the MM800 is the USB passthrough. Not only does it power the mousepad, but it can transfer data as well. This means that you can connect

your mouse, keyboard and even pen drives to the mousepad. Apart from these two distinctions

from the GALAX SNPR mousepad, the rest of the aesthetics of the MM800 are the same. There's a hard surface on the top while there's a rubber-textured pad on the bottom to prevent slipping. If you're looking forward to get one for yourself, we would recommend the

MM800 RGB Polaris over the SNPR because of the extra features it offers while selling at a lower price point of around ₹4,800.

